CPR Is Not A Kiss

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Mature

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F/F

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra)

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Magicat Catra, cafe setting, Christmas theme - sort of, First Meetngs, First Kiss, Fluff, Glimmer is a Good Friend (She-Ra), Bow Is a Good Friend (She-Ra), Catra likes Adora, Adora likes Catra, Down on her luck Catra, Cafe worker Adora

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by masternoveller

Summary

Catra's wallowing in her problems (no job, no money...) and has decided to wallow in the local cafe.
A cafe that the BFS work in.

Adora's staying behind to run the cafe while her friends head off home for family gatherings.

Their day may get better once they finally meet each other.

Notes

Thought I'd get this posted before xmas.
My gift to you.
Enjoy!

See the end of the work for more notes

Catra’s day has been… a shambles to say the least.

Her contract had finished at the tech company she was working for, covering someone’s maternity leave, and she hasn’t got any call backs for work moving forward.

And of course, it’s now Christmas eve and she’ll have zero income coming in from now until… yeah, when she finds her next job.

So, living off her savings it is.

There is one upside though, the place that she was working at was terrible, to say the least.

The pay was low end for her position.

No overtime, despite doing it.

No sick leave, even with a medical certificate.

No holiday leave, makes sense, she was only covering a temp role anyways.

And she doesn’t know if it makes it better or worse, no advancements.

On top of this shitty day, her phone has died, the power has gone out at her place and it’s stinking hot.

Which is how she ends up at the local café down the road.

Sitting back in the booth she’s managed to secure and enjoys the aircon while nursing the one coffee she’s ordered for the last hour, getting looks from the staff as if wanting to ask her to leave.

The magicat ignores them, setting her dead phone on the table next to her and lays her head on her arms and contemplates her life’s decisions and how she got here.

“She’s been here for ages. Hogging that booth.” Glimmer grumbles from behind the counter, clearly annoyed that someone could be so selfish to take up a whole booth for themselves and only order the smallest and cheapest coffee they have.

“Leave our customers be, Glim.” Bow says softly, gently squeezing the smaller woman’s shoulder, “You never know what’s going on with people. Maybe she just needs this.”

“I guess.” Glimmer concedes and steps back as the door to the café opens and her eyes light up, “Adora!”

“Oh, hey guys.” Adora waves to her friends with a big friendly smile, lifting the countertop up and slipping behind the counter and storing her backpack before tying an apron around her waist with a beaming smile on her face, “Can you believe tomorrow is Christmas!?”

Glimmer and Bow both squeal in excitement, the former breathes out like she’s been holding it in for a while, “A few more hours than a whole week off! Woo! Paid leave, here we come!”

“Thank you so much, Adora.” Bow nods sincerely, “Glim and I haven’t gotten Christmas to new year’s off for a few years now. My family have been dying for me to spend it with them and Glimmer’s family is the same.”

“It’s fine, guys.” Adora brushes off their sentiments with a smile, “Besides, someone’s got to run this place while you guys are gone.”

“We could always just shut the shop.” Glimmer suggests, “Then you can come with us. Have a proper break and all.”

“Yeah. That’s a great idea, Glim!” Bow agrees eagerly, “What do you say, Adora?”

“Maybe next year.” Adora replies as she catches the sight of a magicat seemingly wallowing alone in the booth, “What’s going on over there?”

Glimmer shrugs, “She trudged in here about an hour and a half ago, ordered a small black coffee and then has been sitting in that booth ever since.”

“It’s like she’s having an existential crisis.” Bow surmises and then gasps when Catra’s ears perk up and twitch around towards them, under his breath he says, “I think she heard me…”

“She’s not a regular.” Adora tilts her head towards the magicat in the booth.

“Yeah, first time I’ve seen her.” Glimmer nods in agreeance, “It would have been nice if she just took one of the tables with two chairs instead of the entire booth though.”

Adora looks around at the semi busy café and chuckles, “I don’t think anyone really minds, Glim.”

“Oh, customer!” Bow quickly straightens up and puts on his best customer service face.

Catra feels a presence watching over her.

She rolls her eyes and tries to ignore it.

When the presence doesn’t seem to disappear, she picks up her half drunk and most definitely cold coffee and holds it up, “I ordered. I’m allowed to consume my beverage here.”

“Oh, that’s not…” A nervous woman’s voice says from next to the booth, “Uh, do you mind if I sit?”

Catra lowers the cup back down to the table and shrugs, “I’m not the boss of you.”

“Right…” The woman drawls out and then takes a seat on the opposite side of the booth.

“You know it’s rude to stare.” Catra says knowingly and she can already sense the blush or fluster coming from whoever is sitting across from her, “Also, no. You may not touch my ears or tail.”

“I wasn’t.” The woman quickly denies, though Catra can tell from the higher octave in their voice that it’s an obvious lie, “Are you okay?”

The magicat rolls her eyes, her face still buried in her arms as she just huffs back.

“Did you want another drink?” The woman offers.

“Look, lady.” Catra lifts her head and immediately stills, her jaw drops open as her eyes take in the sight of the blonde sitting across from her and all the words just disappear from her mouth, her vocabulary, her brain entirely, “Uh…”

The blonde just looks back, her face pretty now mirroring the magicat’s except she manages to pull her eyes away and blushes and under her breath says, “Stars…”

“Huh?”

“Can I get you another drink?” The blonde asks a lot quieter now than before, her eyes still looking away from Catra’s.

Catra’s eyes drop down to the nametag on her shirt and then blinks back up, “Adora…”

“Yeah.” The blonde’s eyes meet Catra’s once more and she really tries not to stare, “I kind of, work here.”

“Adora…” Catra repeats, other words just don’t seem to follow.

“Are you okay?” Adora brushes a few strands of stray hairs back from her ponytail, “Drink?”

Catra nods dumbly at first before realising that she probably can’t afford to be splurging on overpriced coffee without a job moving

forward, “Actually, no thanks.”

Adora tilts her head, “O-okay…”

Catra stands up and starts to shuffle across to the end of the booth to get out, “I’m just going to…” she juts her thumb behind her and then realises the exit is on the other side, “Go.”

“Hey, wait a minute!” Adora tries to reach out for the magicat, only for them to quickly scurry out leaving her phone on the table along with the half-consumed coffee, “You left your phone…”

Adora picks up the device and taps on the screen.

Nothing happens as she picks up the now discarded coffee cup and the magicat’s phone, walking back to the counter where Glimmer and Bow just watch her.

“What was that about?” Glimmer asks confused by that whole interaction.

“No idea.” Adora replies setting the cup on the counter and then holds up the phone to her friends, “But she left her phone.”

“Oh, gimme!” Glimmer snatches the phone out of Adora’s hand taps on it, “Huh. Must be dead.”

“Why would she be carrying a dead phone around?” Bow asks taking the device from Glimmer and inspecting it.

“Give it here. I’ll charge it up. Maybe she’ll come back for it, or someone might text and we can let them know we have it.” Adora takes the phone from Bow and digs out her phone charger and plugs it in.

Catra grumbles to herself as she walks around aimlessly in the hot afternoon, she’d gone back to her place to check if the power had come back on, but no. Still off. Still extremely hot.

She did see a bunch of electric company workers running around with signs, cherry pickers and tools doing fixes, shrugging as she figures that they're probably trying to get everything reconnected in the searing heat of the day.

As she heads towards the park and the refuge of the tall trees, she reaches into her left pocket and furrows her brows before reaching into her other pockets on her pants.

"Fuck." She grumbles out, "Where the fuck is my phone?"

The magicat checks her pockets once more.

No holes in her pockets which means…

"Ugh. Now I have to go buy another coffee that I can't afford…" Catra mutters out, though when she thinks about it, maybe it won't be so bad if Adora's going to be there…

And with that, she turns back around and starts back towards the café.

"Are you sure you don't want us to stay?" Bow asks, "We can hang out with you and help you close up, Adora."

"Guys. I've done the close up more than enough times. I'll be fine." Adora argues, though she can't help the feeling of love from her friends that want to help, "Besides, don't you guys need to be at the airport tonight? Have you even packed yet?"

Both their eyes widen comically, as they both quickly grab their belonging and make their way out, Bow grinning graciously back, "Thanks Adora. Happy holidays! Don't work too hard!"

"Bye babe! We'll call and text! A LOT!" Glimmer shouts out as she swings the door open and the pair of them rush out, leaving Adora laughing after them.

“Bye guys. Have a good and safe trip.” Adora says to their now vanishing figures.

The door barely has time to close when the sound of it opening has Adora doing a double take, rolling her eyes and about to tell her friends off when she sees the magicat reappear, “Oh.”

Catra walks straight up to the counter and looks around the now near empty café and sees Adora standing there, staring at her.

Her eyes rake up and down the blonde, trying not to focus on any particular part of her and yet, when she looks into her eyes, she becomes that stumbling, bumbling mess all over again.

Shaking it off, quite literally, Catra takes a deep breath, “Hey Adora.”

“Uh, hey…?” Adora replies somewhat shyly, despite working the counter and meeting and greeting a whole lot of customers every day, “Hi?”

Sighing, the magicat holds her hand out, “Catra.”

“Catra.” Adora repeats the magicat’s name before reaching out to shake her hand.

The magicat continues on, their hands still joined, “I think I left my phone here earlier.”

“Oh, yes.” Adora’s eyes glance over to the device charging under the counter, “You did.”

After a few moments of no movement from either party, Catra sighs, “Well… do you think I can get it back?”

Adora quickly taps the screen and then looks back at Catra, “It’s only got ten percent on it.”

“What?” The magicat furrows her brows, “It has zero percent on account it’s very much dead.”

“I’m just charging it up for you now.” Adora admits shyly, “Just in case you tried to call it or I could answer it to let one of your friends know I had your phone and you could come and pick it up from. Not that I was going to like tell a random stranger that you left your phone here. It’d have to be like, someone saved in your contacts or whatever. Or I was going send a text back if that was the case, because it’s not like I’d be able to get into your phone since you’ve probably got a passcode or facial recognition and I look nothing like you…”

Catra just watches the trainwreck of an explanation occur in front of her and can’t help the shit eating grin that happens to grace her face.

“Okay… and now you’re looking at me like I’m some kind of psycho…” Adora tries to pull her hand back only for her breath to hitch when she realises that Catra isn’t letting go, “Uh, hi…?”

“You’re kind of…” Catra starts to say.

“Sorry! I’m not usually this… uh, awkward…” Adora grimaces at her own words, “I’m usually really good. Great even with the whole, uh, customer service thing…”

“Breathe, princess.” Catra rolls her eyes but the grin is still on her face, “You’re going to collapse on me and then I’ll have to do CPR on an idiot.”

Adora’s brain short circuits, the image of Catra’s lips on her, even if it is if she happens to be unconscious as her feeling very warm and then she frowns, pulling her hand back from Catra’s and then slapping her lightly on the shoulder making the magicat chuckles, “Hey! I’m not an idiot!”

Catra just grins back at Adora, an eyebrow lifted as she does a quick glance around to see the very few people still within the

café look up and then promptly look away, “Sure, you aren’t. Besides, what’s that saying…?”

“What saying?” Adora crosses her arms over her chest and narrows her eyes at the magicat.

Snapping her fingers like she just remembered, “The customer is always right. And by that rhetoric, me calling you an idiot would not only be accurate, but it would also be right.”

“Stars…” Adora breathes out dramatically and then retorts, “Well, in that case, I’m keeping your phone. Holding it hostage until you’re nicer to me.”

“Oh, is that right?” Catra’s newfound confidence surprises herself.

“Yes. That’s right.” Adora nods defiantly.

Catra steps forward, her front now flush against the counter as she tilts her head, “I can be *very nice* to you…”

Adora visibly gulps down, a blush coating her cheeks as she takes a step back, hoping that the small amount of space will be enough to quell her very inappropriate thoughts, and even with her throat dry, she asks, “How?”

“I can show you.” Catra puts her hands on the counter, her ears swivel back when she hears the door open and without needing to look, steps off to the side, “Maybe later.”

Adora quickly pulls herself together, putting her customer service game face back on to serve the couple that have just come in, all the while feeling Catra’s eyes on her the whole time.

Catra sits down at the booth she had previously occupied earlier that day, her eyes never leaving Adora.

And Adora catches the magicat’s eyes on her constantly.

But it’s not creepy.

Or weird.

If anything, every time their eyes meet, Adora pulls a face trying to crack the magicat’s composure.

And every time, Catra ends up looking away with a smile or even laughing openly.

They play this game until it’s closing time and Adora’s walked over to the front door and turned the sign over from OPEN to CLOSED.

When she turns around, she yelps out as Catra’s standing right in front of her.

“Stars! Fuck! CATRA!” Adora puts her hand on her chest, trying to slow her racing heart, “You’re going to be the death of me!”

“So, it sounds like you want me to do CPR on you.” Catra drawls and Adora shoves the magicat back playfully.

“You’re a menace.” She huffs out with no heat.

“I’m trying to be nice.” Catra shoves her hands into her pockets, “I’d take you out for dinner but then I won’t be able to afford any to eat afterwards.”

Adora walks back to the counter, unplugs Catra’s phone and holds it out to her, “Here. You’ve been nice enough to stay until closing and keeping me from falling asleep.”

Catra gingerly takes her phone back, tapping on it as it lights up, she quickly unlocks it while Adora starts to go through her closing procedures.

After a moment, Catra grins, walking back towards the exit, “Hey, Adora?”

“Hm?” Adora asks, looking over at her curiously.

“Don’t lock me out, please.” Catra says as she steps out of the cafe and then taps on her phone a few more times, bringing the device up to her ear.

A few minutes later, Adora is about ready to turn off the last of the lights and lock up when Catra comes back inside.

“Thanks, princess.” Catra says trying to hide her smile.

“No problems.” Adora says as she throws her backpack on, “You look… happy?”

“I guess I am.” Catra replies, her mood lifted significantly.

“That’s good.” The blonde turns off the light for the café and then ushers Catra back outside, closing the door and locking it behind them, “Well, it was nice to meet you Catra. I hope you have a merry Christmas tomorrow.”

“Well, here’s the thing, Adora.” Catra says rubbing the back of her neck nervously, “Thanks for charging up my phone and keeping it safe.”

“That’s okay, Catra.” Adora replies holding onto the straps of her bag.

“Hey, what are you doing tonight?” Catra asks.

“Uh, it’s Christmas eve… my friends are going home to see their families so…as sad as it sounds… nothing much.” Adora says.

“Do you, would you like to come over to my place?” Catra nervously asks and then groans out, “Actually scratch that. There’s probably still no power at my place…”

“Are you, are you asking me out?” Adora teases with a smirk.

“No.” Catra quickly says, “Because we’re already out. So, technically…”

“Now, who’s the idiot?” The blonde grins back, “Why don’t you just come to my place?”

“Huh?”

“We can share a frozen pizza and watch a bad Christmas movie.” Adora suggests, “Unless… you don’t want to, which also cool… but, yeah. If you want to.”

“I’d love to.” Catra says without missing a beat, “Lead the way princess.”

With the pizza heating up in Adora’s oven, the pair end up sitting on the couch, as promised a terrible Christmas movie on the tv as Catra leans back, “Today has been… interesting.”

“Oh yeah?” Adora takes a sip from her glass of wine, “Are you sure you don’t want a drink?”

“Yeah.” Catra nods, “I was wallowing in my own self defeat this morning after my last work contract finished up and I hadn’t had any call backs moving forward.”

Adora just nods, letting Catra continue on.

“Then the power went out early this morning, and I doubt it’s back on now.” Catra says, “My phone died and its’ stinking hot today. And then you came and yeah, everything didn’t seem as bleak. But still dire. Then I met you, and it felt… better.”

Adora smiles, “When you ducked out… you came back in, different. Lighter.”

“I got offered a position at another tech company.” Catra replies, a smile on her face as she speaks, “It pays four times more than

what I was getting at my last job, with overtime, leave benefits and it's actually not too far from where I'm staying. And if you hadn't charged up my phone… I wouldn't have been able to even see it."

"I'm glad I could help." Adora says, a smile mirroring Catra's.

"So, what nice thing can I do for you, Adora?" Catra turns to face her completely.

"Uh… it's fine, Catra. I don't need anything." Adora tries to brush it off.

"My CPR idea seems to interest you." Catra says, "Though…"

Adora's eyes widen as Catra leans in closer, "What… what are you doing?"

"Tell me to stop, if you want me to." Catra whispers coming closer, "Just… say the word."

Adora's eyes flick down from Catra's eyes and down to her lips for a moment and she finds herself leaning up to meet the magicat's lips, pushing Catra back onto the couch and throwing her leg over the top, straddling her.

The blonde deepens the kiss, moaning into Catra's mouth, "Keep going."

Catra grins into the next kiss, her hands securely on Adora's hips to keep her steady, "This is way better than CPR."

Adora snorts out a laugh, Catra joining in as the blonde rests her forehead on Catra's, "Merry Christmas, Catra."

"Merry Christmas, Adora." Catra replies and then adds, "I guess you have been very nice this year… a very *good girl."*

The blonde shivers at that as she feels Catra kissing along her neck, "Yes… I've been very good… I think I deserve, ah, that

present…”

With another soft kiss against Adora’s neck, Catra whispers into the blonde’s ear, “Well, let me give you that present, princess…”

“Stars…” Adora breathes out as Catra brings her back in for another kiss.

End Notes

I wrote this in an afternoon - so spelling and grammar errors... yeah, my bad.

Thanks for reading!

Throws some kudos my way if you want to - no pressure.
And if you feel like it, comment away.
It's always nice to hear from you guys and gals and inbetweens.

Enjoy your time off (if you have it) otherwise, thanks for plugging along!
Stay safe out there peeps!

I'm on Tumble - @masternoveller

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!